A TAKE-HOME GUIDE FOR WOMEN 40+

THE HAIR CARE PYRAMID

Because a better hair routine starts with the foundations, not another bottle.



START AT THE BASE

Adapted from Dr. Jaishree Sharad's conversation with Menopause India.

PUT THE PYRAMID INTO PRACTICE

SMALL CHANGES.
STRONGER FOUNDATIONS.

You do not need a complicated hair routine. Start with these five priorities.

01

FOOD FIRST

Hair is made largely of **keratin, a protein**. Build regular meals around foods such as **dal, chana, rajma, soy, tofu, eggs or fish**, according to your needs.

02

SUPPLEMENTS: ONLY IF NEEDED

If you notice hair fall or thinning, ask a dermatologist whether a nutrient gap may be involved. **Iron, vitamin D, zinc or biotin are not automatic prescriptions for everyone.**

03

STOP SMOKING

If you smoke, getting support to quit benefits your overall health.

04

BE GENTLE WITH HEAT

Use hot tools less often. Keep the dryer away from your hair.

05

LOOK AFTER STRESS

Make room for movement, rest and a way to unwind.

Extra gentle-care tip: shampoo the scalp, condition the hair lengths and blot with a towel instead of rubbing.

KNOW WHAT YOU ARE SEEING

HAIR FALL IS NOT ONE SINGLE THING.

Dr. Jaishree describes shedding, breakage, dryness and thinning around perimenopause. These clues can help you explain what has changed.

01

MORE SHEDDING

You notice more strands in the shower, on your pillow or in your hairbrush.

WHAT TO DO Note **when it began** and whether it is getting better or worse.

02

BREAKAGE + DRYNESS

Hair snaps, feels rough, looks dull or has lost its usual shine.

WHAT TO DO Check your **heat, styling and handling habits** and use gentle conditioning.

03

VISIBLE THINNING

Your parting looks wider or your overall hair density seems reduced.

WHAT TO DO Book a **dermatologist assessment** instead of buying another product.

Important: these are observations, not a diagnosis. Several causes of hair loss can overlap.

SAVE THIS BEFORE YOUR APPOINTMENT

YOUR 2-MINUTE HAIR CHECK-IN

A little detail can be more useful than a shelf full of products.

JOT DOWN WHAT HAS CHANGED

- When did you first notice it?
- What is different: shedding, breakage or thinning?
- Any new medicines, supplements, products or major stress?

BEFORE YOU BUY BIOTIN

There is limited evidence that biotin helps hair without a deficiency, and high-dose biotin can alter some blood test results. **Tell your clinician if you take it.**

TAKE THESE QUESTIONS TO YOUR DERMATOLOGIST

1. Could this be shedding, breakage, or a type of hair loss?
2. Do my symptoms suggest any blood tests or nutrient deficiencies?
3. What treatment or routine fits my cause, and when should I follow up?

MORE CONVERSATIONS THAT MATTER: @menopauseindia

Sources: Dr. Jaishree Sharad episode; AAD hair care; NIH biotin fact sheet. Educational only.